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Business Retention and Expansion Program for the Village of Bradley: Bradley Economic Development Corporation Pratical Capstone Project

Denee P. Brooks

Cole W. Jones

Dasjah Lewis

Donat Ramadani

Nicole B. Sheppard

See next page for additional authors

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Author

Denee P. Brooks, Cole W. Jones, Dasjah Lewis, Donat Ramadani, Nicole B. Sheppard, Tamika Sutton, and Tamera A. Taylor

BUSINESS RETENTION AND EXPANSION PROGRAM FOR THE VILLAGE OF BRADLEY: BRADLEY ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION

PRACTICAL CAPSTONE PROJECT

BY

Deneen P. Brooks

BA, Psychology, University of Wisconsin-Whitewater, 1990

Cole W. Jones

BA, Park and Recreation Administration, Illinois State University, 2022

Dasjah Lewis

BA, Psychology, Governors State University, 2022

Donat Ramadani

BA, Political Science, Governors State University, 2022

Nicole B. Sheppard

BS, Business, Finance, University of Illinois at Chicago, 1998

Tamika Sutton

BA, Interdisciplinary Studies State University, 2021

Tamera A. Taylor

BA, Finance, Chicago State University, 1995

CAPSTONE PROJECT REPORT

Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements.

For the Degree of Master of Public Administration

Governors State University

May 2025

WE, THE UNDERSIGNED MEMBERS OF THE COMMITTEE,

HAVE APPROVED THIS CAPSTONE

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Tamika Sutton

Tamera A. Taylor

COMMITTEE MEMBERS

Natalia Ermasova, Ph.D. (Chair) Public Administration

Mary Bruce, Ph.D. Public Administration

Craig Anderson, MOL Public Administration, Village of Bradley

Governors State University

University Park, IL 60484

May 2025

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Introduction

The Village of Bradley (VoB) entered a collaborative relationship with Governors State University (GSU), College of Art and Science, Division of Arts and Letters, Public Policy and Administration Unit for the Spring 2025 semester. The VoB, located in Kankakee County, Illinois, is seeking the research of economic development corporations in Illinois and creating a website for Bradley Economic Development Corporation.

The VoB has a small-town environment, with hopes of reversing the loss of the population base and developing a new revenue stream. The Village of Bradley has a motto of "Proud of Our Past, Focused on Our Future". Its name was changed from North Kankakee to Bradley in 1895 after the David Bradley Manufacturing Company agreed to move its operations to the growing industrialized area. It sits in the scenic Kankakee River Valley of Illinois and is part of a larger urban area that includes the City of Kankakee and the Villages of Manteno and Bourbonnais in Kankakee County. The Village has a current population of approximately 15,695 people (U.S. Census, 2024). According to the Village of Bradley (2021), the median household income in Bradley is projected to increase by 9% from $61,800 to $67,400 by 2024. The VoB is hopeful this Bradley Economic Development Corporation will support economic development projects.

Needs Assessment

Bradley is a major employment center and is growing in tourism. Approximately 14,700 people are employed in Bradley's two zip codes (Village of Bradley, 2021). This accounts for over 36% of jobs in the County/MSA. Retail accounts for about one-third of the local workforce, including those employed in retail, hospitality, and food services (Bryson, 2018). Retail employment has remained stable despite major changes within the retail sector. Industrial is the second largest component of the VoB's workforce. Despite some employment losses in the early 2000s, industrial employment has rebounded since 2010. Recent growth in the Manufacturing, Transportation and Warehousing sectors has offset declines in Construction employment. The Healthcare and Professional and Business Services sectors appear to be the fastest-growing private

employment sectors. Office growth has been driven by growth in the Professional, Scientific and Technical Services sector, which has increased in more than 550 employees since 2002. The Healthcare sector similarly added approximately 525 employees between 2002 and 2017. Overall, employment has remained stable, with a +0.4% CAGR in total employment between 2002 and 2017.

While employment has been historically stable, two key anchors along the Kinzie Avenue/Route 50 Corridor have recently begun major expansion plans that are anticipated to bring 1,000+ new employees to unincorporated areas adjacent to Bradley. Both the CSL Behring expansion and Nucor expansion will create a combined 1,000 new jobs (CSL, 2022).

Bradley's Economic Development Corporation (BEDC) is designed to promote economic growth and development for the Village of Bradley. The mission of BEDC is to strengthen Bradley's economy and increase the standard of living for all residents through attracting and retaining diverse businesses, encouraging investments, fostering innovation, and facilitating job creation.

Goals and Objectives

Goals

For the Spring Semester of 2025, the Master of Public Administration Capstone students tasked with adding to the village's efforts by assisting with creating a website for Bradley Economic Development Corporation (BEDC). MPA students provided comprehensive research on economic development corporations (EDCs) operating within the state of Illinois. This research identifies strategies that can be effectively applied to Bradley's economic development initiatives, including Enterprise Zones and TIFs. This research focuses on the structure, staff, governance, and best practices of successful EDC' websites. The BEDC's website is modeled on exemplary EDC websites, incorporating key features such as business resources, investment opportunities, demographic and market data, available incentives, and success stories to attract and support local

businesses and investors. The overall goals for this Practical Project are to collect the following information:

1. Bradley Economic Development Corporation
    - Mission Statement
    - About the BEDC
    - Board of Directors
    - Staff
2. Village of Bradley
    - Community Profile
    - Demographics
    - Transportation
    - Other Local Governments-Schools, County, etc.
    - Utilities
    - Change of Zoning Process
    - Zoning Map ,
    - Building department Documents
3. Economic Development
    - Available properties
    - Local Grants & Business Assistance Programs (Create Commercial Facade Grant Program & Small Business Loan Program)
    - TIFs (Include Maps)
    - Enterprise Zone Maps and Information

Capstone Project Objectives-

Objective 1.1: Conduct a comprehensive analysis of the Bradley Economic Development Corporation (BEDC), including its mission, governance structure, staff, and operational strategies.

Objective 1.2: Develop a detailed description of the Village of Bradley, including a community profile, demographics, transportation infrastructure, local government entities, utilities, and zoning regulations.

Objective 1.3: Identify and evaluate economic development mechanisms and incentives available in Bradley, such as Tax Increment Financing (TIF) districts, enterprise zones, local grants, and small business support programs.

Objective 1.4: Analyze available commercial and industrial properties in Bradley, including their zoning, infrastructure, and potential for development.

Objective 1.5: Research and develop recommendations for a Commercial Façade Grant Program and a Small Business Loan Program, assessing their feasibility and potential impact on local businesses.

Objective 1.6: Conduct a thorough analysis of Tax Increment Financing (TIF) districts in Bradley, including their financial structure, geographic scope, and effectiveness in stimulating economic growth.

Objective 1.7: Evaluate Enterprise Zone Maps and Information, identifying opportunities for business incentives and economic development strategies.

Objective 1.8: Design a user-friendly and informative website template for the BEDC, incorporating key sections such as mission, leadership, contact information, available properties, grants, and zoning documents.

Practical Project

Bradley Economic Development Corporation (BEDC)

Mission & Vision

Mission

To lead and promote business interests that support equitable economic growth for all community stakeholders in the Village of Bradley. Through a shared vision with the community, the Village of Badley Economic Development Corporation is committed to maintaining and improving economic vitality through the retention, expansion, and attraction of all types of commercial enterprise that are conducive to supporting and contributing to the economic growth and vitality of our proud Village of Bradley.

Vision

We will endeavor to develop policies and procedures that all Village of Bradley residents and stakeholders can contribute to and benefit from economic opportunities. The Village of Bradley is a welcoming and safe community of neighbors focused on preserving a unique hometown feel while creating a path for future success**.**

Bradely Economic Development Corporation

The Village of Bradley Economic Development Corporation (BEDC), a not-for profit agency, established in December 2024, is responsible for strategies that elevate Bradley's position as Illinois' center for business, innovation, and transformation. The Village of Bradley's Economic Development Corporation is dedicated to fostering a thriving and sustainable local economy by supporting business growth, job creation, and community development. Our mission is to partner with businesses, government agencies, and community leaders to create an environment where innovation, entrepreneurship, and investment can flourish.

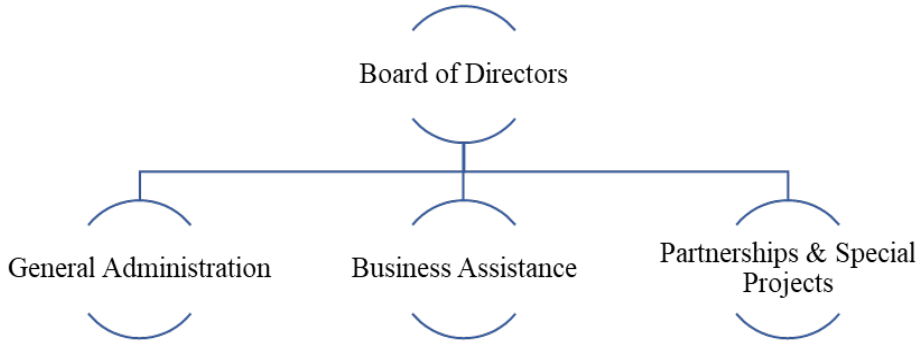
Board of Directors

The Board of Directors comprises five forward-thinking leaders from across the community, appointed by the Village Board serving two-year terms. Hereafter, Directors are elected after serving a two-year term by Board of Directors to be reappointed by Village Board. Directorship is unpaid positions with independence and interdependence of various governing bodies of Bradley. Board Meetings are quarterly.

Staff

Bradley Economic Development Corporation Staff will carry the various tasks and responsibilities. The Board will oversee the following departments: General Administration, Business Assistance, Partnerships & Special Projects. These departments reflect the operations critical to supporting BEDC mission. Total staff has yet to be determined. See Figure 1. Organization Chart.

Figure 1. Organization Chart of BEDC.



General Administration

General Administration refers to the management and coordination of day-to-day operations. BEDC staffing will include department head roles of Chief Financial Officer, Senior Accountant, and Administrative Operations Coordinator to oversee the day-to-day operation. The Chief Operating Officer (CFO) will be responsible for managing the financial actions of BEDC. A seasoned professional, the Comptroller will have expertise to oversee the accounting and financial functions within the organization (See Table 1). In addition, an Administrative

Operations Coordinator will provide a structured, efficient administrative workflow function that supports the organization. Essentially, general administration ensures that an organization runs smoothly with supporting staff. These tasks will include:

- Planning and organizing by setting goals and developing strategies and resources to achieve objectives.
- Human resource management duties include hiring and training employees.
- Financial management of budgets, accounting, and monthly financial reporting.
- Procurement management will oversee purchase requests for office supplies, equipment, and building maintenance.

Table 1. General Administration Department Head Responsibilities

Department Head Title	Core Responsibilities
Chief Financial Officer (CFO)	❖ Strategic goals and initiatives analysis, budgeting, and forecasting. ❖ Cash flow management. ❖ Financial reporting for stakeholders. ❖ Managing financial risks.
Comptroller	❖ Preparing financial statements in compliance with regulations. ❖ Preparation of budgets and financial forecasts. ❖ Assessing internal controls and risk.
Administrative Coordinator	❖ Organizing and coordinating meetings, appointments, and events. ❖ Managing office supplies, equipment, and building maintenance. ❖ Assisting with budgeting and financial reporting.

Business Assistance

Business Assistance refers to support for resources provided to businesses to foster growth, development, and sustainability. The BEDC department head roles include EDBC Village Director, Business Analyst Manager, and Property & Grant Manager. The EDBC Village Director is the primary bridge between village administration and BEDC board. A Business Analyst Manager role is critical with data analysis of actionable strategies executed to move EDBC's mission forward. Sequentially, Property & Grant Manager oversees property-related initiatives and manages grant programs to support economic growth (See Table 2). These services include:

- Foster strategies that enhance business networking.
- Monitor village owned property opportunities.
- Create financial assistance through grants and Tax Incremental Financing.
- Guide regulatory compliance.

Table 2. Business Assistance Department Head Responsibilities

Department Head Title	Core Responsibilities
Village Director	❖ Facilitating communication between the village government and EDBC board. ❖ Assisting in the planning of economic development programs for business recruitment, retention, and expansion. ❖ Acting as the village's representative at board meetings, regional events, and discussions with stakeholders.
Business Analyst Manager	❖ Collaborating with stakeholders to align business analysis initiatives with the board's economic goals and objectives. ❖ Analyzing economic trends, market data, and community needs to aid decision-making for development projects.
Property & Grant Manager	❖ Maintain records on property transactions, property acquisition, redevelopment, and disposition according to strategic goals. ❖ Identifying, applying for, and managing grants to fund economic development.

Partnerships & Special Projects

Partnerships & Special Projects Manager is a consolidated role. The Partnerships role focuses on fostering and nurturing strategic collaborations between local businesses, community organizations that align with BEDC's mission. Special Projects manage unique initiatives that perpetuate Bradley's growth. All these efforts include:

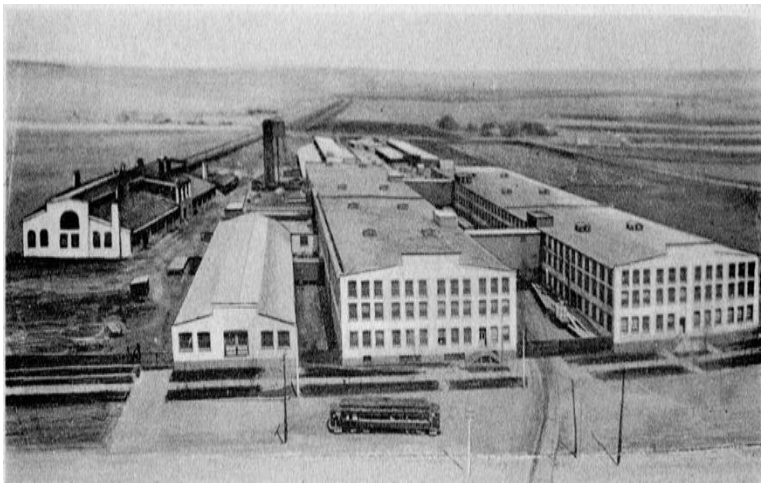
- Leading the planning and execution of innovative or high-priority projects.
- Design programs that address specific community or economic needs.
- Lead cross-jurisdictional efforts.

Community Profile

History

The Village of Bradley has a motto of "Proud of Our Past, Focused on Our Future." Its name changed from North Kankakee to Bradley in 1895 after the David Bradley Manufacturing Company agreed to move its operations to the growing industrialized area (Klasey, 2021). It sits in the scenic Kankakee River Valley of Illinois and is part of a larger urban area that includes the City of Kankakee and the Villages of Manteno and Bourbonnais in Kankakee County.

**Photos courtesy of the Kankakee County Historical Society. View of Kankakee River west (downstream) of Bradley*



**Photos courtesy of the Kankakee County Historical Society. The Bradley Manufacturing Company factory, later the David Bradley Implement Co., located at the north end of Schuyler Avenue in Bradley Photoengraving from 1900 pictorial booklet, Souvenir of Kankakee by Irvin W. Powell.*

Since its establishment in the late 1800s, Bradley has grown in manufacturing, shopping, and population. Bradley is now home to 80% of the county's retail and commercial businesses with its residential population at approximately 16,000 people (Nugent & Morrey, 2024). The nearness of the Kankakee River and Illinois Central Railroad played large roles in the development of Bradley and its surrounding area. Points of interest in and around Bradley include various festivals, concert series, theatre productions, museums, sporting events, and much more. There is an interchange with Interstate 57 serving the community with further access to Interstates; I-80, I-355, and I-55. Located in the scenic Kankakee River Valley, just south of the Chicago Metropolitan Area, Bradley forms a key part of a broader urban network that includes Kankakee, Manteno, and Bourbonnais.

Economic Development and Growth

Bradley boasts a strong commercial presence, with numerous local businesses and nationally recognized brands, as well as a variety of hotel accommodations. An interchange with Interstate 57 connects Bradley to I-80, I-355, and I-55, further enhancing accessibility and business opportunities. Bradley's economy has remained stable, with significant expansions underway.

Two major companies—CSL Behring and Nucor—are expanding operations along the Kinzie Avenue/Route 50 Corridor, bringing a combined 1,000+ new jobs to areas adjacent to Bradley. Two key economic corridors anchor the village:

1. Kinzie Avenue/Route 50: A regional commercial hub that includes Northfield Square Mall, big-box retailers, and over 275 businesses.
2. West Broadway Street: The historic Village Center, home to over 110 neighborhood-serving businesses.

Village of Bradley invested in three main economic development projects:

1. Perry Farm Park
2. Bradley Sports Complex
3. Indoor Water Park.

Perry Farm Park

In 2022, Bradley started annexing the Perry Farm Park, allowing the village to expand the park's amenities. In addition, Perry Farm Park also serves as home to the Exploration Station, a children's museum, and the Park District Administrative Offices within the historical Perry Farm House. Perry Farm Park has been enriching the lives of the community through recreation, education, and preservation across 170 acres of lush farmland nestled in Bradley, Illinois. This historic farmstead has been offering recreational opportunities for outdoor enthusiasts and families to explore fields, trails, and riverside caves for generations. However, changes were needed to ensure this park is sustainable.

The economic development plan was designed to revamp the park to add value to its current allure. With an initial investment budget of $4 million dollars, the local government of Bradley created the economic development plan to revamp the park to add value to its current allure. These enhancements include a brewery, horseback riding, accessibility to the Kankakee River, and a community performance stage, improving paved trails, open recreational fields,

playground equipment, shelters, picnic areas, farm animals, Indian caves, fruit tree orchards, and flower gardens.

Bradley 315 Sports Complex

The Bradley 315 Sports Complex, branded as "Where Families Come to Play," is a proposed multi-use amusement area that will be financed through a mix of public and private funding. The complex will host:

- 9 to 16 baseball tournaments per year (~100 teams per tournament)
- 7 to 13 softball tournaments per year (~70 teams per tournament)
- New events attracting 800 athletes and 1,200 spectators per tournament.

This development aims to attract visitors from beyond the immediate geographic area while supporting local businesses, expanding employment and economic opportunities. At the Bradley Village Board meeting, trustees approved a $5.1 million contract to Piggush-Simoneau Inc., of Kankakee, for the buildout of about 10,000 square feet of building space at the youth baseball and softball complex.

Indoor water park

In 2024, Bradley planned the construction of 90,000 square feet of indoor water park on a 14.09-acre parcel of vacant land in 2025 (Provost, 2023). This water park was proposed to have a variety of water entertainment options, including a lazy river, wave pool, 4-lane mat racer slides, speed slides, drop slides, children's pool, zero-depth pool, an 8,000 square adult pool, multi-person raft rides, surf machine, and 7,000 square-foot outdoor pool with a floating obstacle course. The project's design is proposed for a year and construction of the development - within two years. The development of the subject waterpark will result in the following combined operation and visitor spending economic impacts over ten years.

Tourism and Destination Appeal of the Village of Bradley

Bradley offers a variety of entertainment, cultural, and recreational activities, including festivals, concerts, theatre productions, museums, and sporting events. The Bradley 315 Sports Complex will further enhance the community's appeal, attracting thousands of athletes and spectators annually. Bradley's proximity to Northfield Square Mall and easy access to Interstate 57 make it an ideal location for tourism-related investments. Key advantages include:

- 13 retail stores
- 9 restaurants
- 6 hotels with 422 rooms
- Daily traffic of 27,700 vehicles on I-57

The 90-minute drive-time population includes a diverse mix of urban dwellers, young professionals, and empty nesters. By developing a trend-forward tourism experience, Bradley has the potential to attract new visitors who seek small-town charm combined with modern amenities.

Demographics

The Village of Bradley is in Kankakee County, Illinois, south of the Chicago metropolitan area. Bradley is home to 15,184 residents in the year 2025. Bradley is currently declining at a rate of -0.26%annually and its population has decreased by -1.28% since the most recent census, which recorded a population of 15,381 in 2020. Of the current population, the ethnic composition was White (82.64%), 5.87% identifying as Black or African American, 3.18% identifying Other Race, and smaller percentages for Asian, Native American, Native Hawaiian or Pacific Islander and multiracial populations.

Table 3. Demographics information (race/ethnicity)

Race and Hispanic Origin	Bradley, IL	United States
White alone, percent	82.6%	75.3%
Black alone, percent (a)(a)	5.9%	13.7%
American Indian and Alaska Native alone, percent (a)(a)	0.2%	1.3%
Asian alone, percent (a)(a)	0.4%	6.4%
Native Hawaiian and Other Pacific Islander alone, percent (a)(a)	0.0%	0.3%

Source: U.S. Census (2025).

The median age in Bradley is 35.5 years: 33 years for males and 37.3 years for females. Of this population 92.7% have obtained a high school diploma or higher. There are a total of 6,099 households in the Village of Bradley. Also, Bradley's average per capita income is $46,180 and household income levels show a median of $62,940. The poverty rate stands at 8.86%.

Table 4. Demographics information (Housing, Education, Income) Village of Bradley in 2025.

Description	Bradley, IL	United States
Housing Units, July 1, 2023, (V2023)	X	145,344,636
Owner-occupied housing unit rate, 2019-2023	63.4%	65.0%
Median value of owner-occupied housing units, 2019-2023	$164,400	$303,400
Median selected monthly owner costs - with a mortgage, 2019-2023	$1,445	$1,902
Median selected monthly owner costs -without a mortgage, 2019-2023	$586	$612
Median gross rent, 2019-2023	$1,181	$1,348
Building Permits, 2023	**X**	1,511,102
Families & Living Arrangements		
Households, 2019-2023	6,099	127,482,865
Persons per household, 2019-2023	2.49	2.54
Living in the same house 1 year ago, percent of persons aged 1 year+, 2019-2023	93.8%	87.3%
Language other than English spoken at home, percent of persons aged 5 years+, 2019-2023	12.2%	22.0%
Computer and Internet Use		

Households with a computer, percent, 2019-2023	95.4%	94.8%
Households with a broadband Internet subscription, percent, 2019-2023	88.6%	89.7%
Education		
High school graduate or higher, percent of persons aged 25 years+, 2019-2023	92.7%	89.4%
Bachelor's degree or higher, percent of persons aged 25 years+, 2019-2023	17.7%	35.0%
Health		
With a disability, under age 65 years, percent, 2019-2023	8.9%	9.1%
Persons without health insurance, under age 65 years, percent	8.6%	9.5%
Economy		
In civilian labor force, total, percent of population age 16 years+, 2019-2023	69.7%	63.0%
In civilian labor force, female, percent of population age 16 years+, 2019-2023	66.0%	58.7%
Total accommodation and food services sales, 2022 ($1,000)(c)	70,273	1,196,315,575
Total health care and social assistance receipts/revenue, 2022 ($1,000)(c)	67,009	3,330,304,719
Total transportation and warehousing receipts/revenue, 2022 ($1,000)(c)	4,331	1,316,303,546
Total retail sales, 2022 ($1,000)(c)	688,602	6,974,691,329
Total retail sales per capita, 2022(c)	$45,240	$20,928
Transportation		
Mean travel time to work (minutes), workers aged 16 years+, 2019-2023	24.1	26.6
Income & Poverty		
Median households' income (in 2023 dollars), 2019-2023	$62,940	$78,538
Per capita income in past 12 months (in 2023 dollars), 2019-2023	$34,140	$43,289
Persons in poverty, percent	8.9%	11.1%

Source: U.S. Census (2025).

Transportation

Geographical Statistics

Bradley is a village in Kankakee County, Illinois, United States. It is a suburb of the city of Kankakee. The population was 15,585 at the 2010 census, up from 12,784 at the 2000 census, up from 12,784 at the 2000 census. The Village is a principal city of the Kankakee-Bradley Metropolitan Statistical Area. It is bordered to the south by the city of Kankakee and to the west by the village of Bourbonnais Interstate 57 and it passes through the village, with access from Exit 315 (Illinois Route 50). The I-57 leads 56 miles (90km) north to Chicago and south 76 miles (122 km) to Champaign. According to the 2010 census, Bradely has a total area of 7.24 square miles (18.75 km2), all land.

Distance from Major Illinois Cities

City Name	*Distance to Miles*
Chicago	58 miles (1-hour)
Rockford	141 miles (2-hours)
Aurora	60 miles (1-hour)
Springfield	159 miles (2.65-hours)
Joliet	47 miles (1-hour)
Naperville	66 miles (1.2-hours)

Transportation Access

The River Valley Metro Mass Transit District provides a bus service on multiple routes connecting Bradley to destinations in the Kankakee area. O'Hare and Midway Airports are only minutes away and offer international access. A network of interstate highways provides an efficient mode of travel to the metropolitan area and beyond.

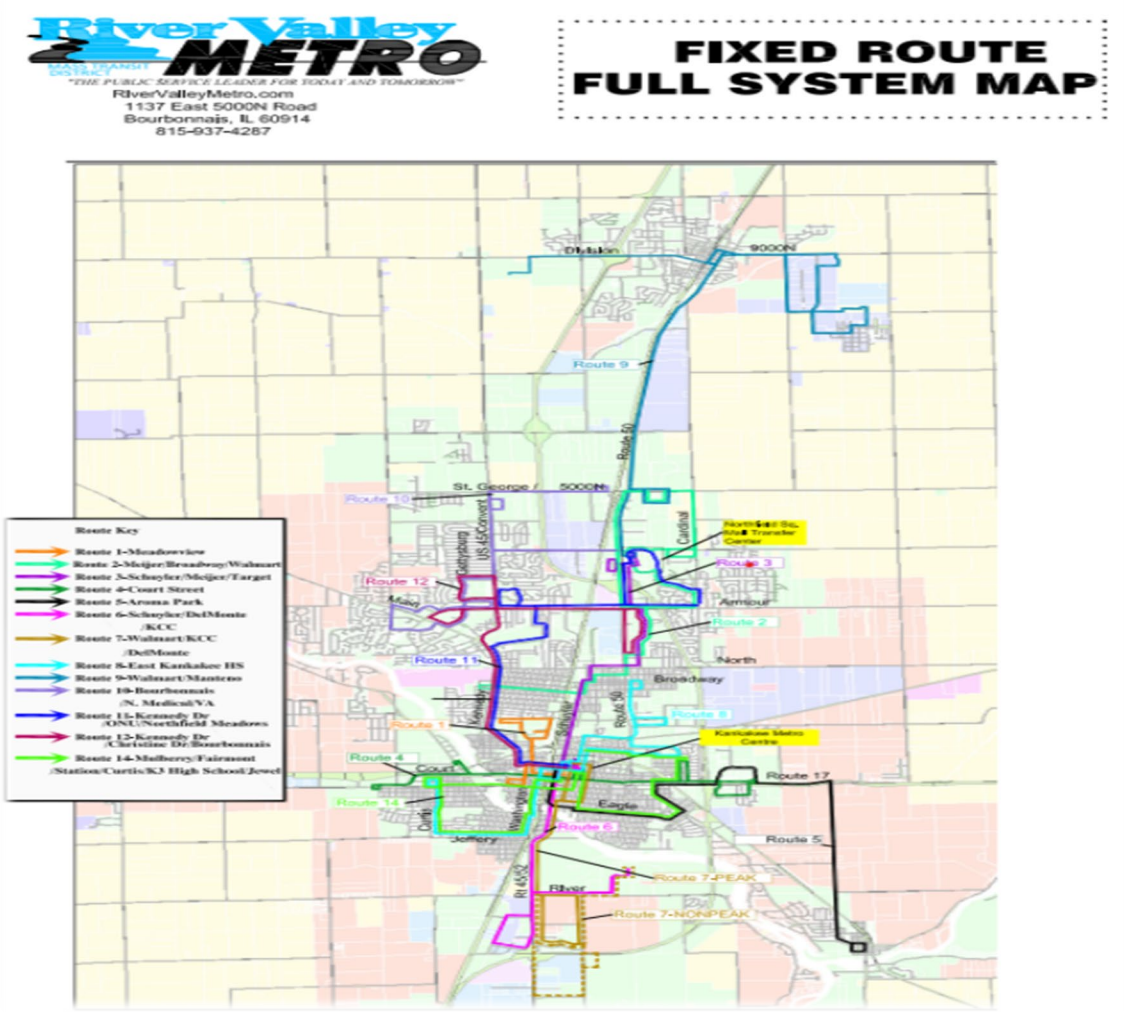
River Valey Metro rides on all 11 local routes serving over 300 bus stops. In addition, Metro plus paratransit service, are free every Monday. However, normal fares apply for Midway.

Manteno to O'Hare bus services, depart from Manteno Metro Centre station. Manteno to O'Hare bus services, operated by River Valley Metro, arrive at Midway Airport station.

- O'Hare International Airport www.ohare.com
  - Seventy-three miles from Bradley
  - District service to more than 60 international destinations
  - U.S. Customs Port available at the International Terminal Five

- Midway Airport -www.flychicago,com
  - Forty-nine miles from Bradley
  - Direct service to eighty-nine cities, some international destinations
  - U.S. Customer Port: Yes
  - Average number of daily flights: 766

Full System Map – https://www.rivervalleymetor.com



Other Local Governments

Bradley School District 61

Bradley Elementary School District 61 is in Bradley, Illinois, which is in central Kankakee County. District 61 maintains its commitment to providing students with a rich opportunity to strive for excellence in their pursuit of achieving both short -term and long-term goals. The School District's mission and vision statements outlines the partnership that co-exists between parents, the community, and Bradely School District. The district is comprised of two elementary schools and one middle school, and they are Bradley West Elementary School, Bradley East Elementary School, and Bradley Central Middle School. In addition, the district embodies several departments that offer an array of specialized services to the entire student body.

The Bradley School District's Curriculum & Instruction department provides an oversight regarding all educational programs and professional development ensuring that practice standards are in place for students. The department is also responsible for delivery of effective teaching models while providing instructional materials. The food services department has a primary focus on providing dietary nutrition in compliance with the health and safety standards.

The health services department aids the district by managing the student body's medical needs including sustained injuries and illnesses. It administers medications, promotes health education, and ensures a safe and healthy school environment by addressing health concerns while assisting with emergencies.

- The transportation Department assumes the task of providing transportation for all students to and from their home environment.
- The Human Resources Department manages employee-related functions which may include general hiring practices, employee training, and performance management. It ensures compliance with labor management laws as well as handling employee benefits and compensation.
- The Special Services Department provides tailored support and services to students with special needs and disabilities, ensuring they have equal access to educational programs and support. The department develops individualized education plan (IEP's), adapts teaching methods, and offer resources to meet the unique needs of each student, promoting their academic, emotional, and social growth.

Bradley East Elementary School

Bradley East Elementary School is a public school that serves PK-2. Total enrollment is 529. The student population is made up of 53% female students and 47% males. The school enrolls 56% poor students. There are thirty-eight equivalent full-time teachers and 1 full-time school counselor.

Bradley Central Middle School

Bradley Central has a central focus on student engagement for the entire student body in an active learning environment. They have chosen to implement the necessary educational curriculum and instructional tools that are competitive and determined to be essential to lifelong academic growth. It has been documented that Bradley Central utilizes research-based strategies and are working collaboratively to promote active learning and feel empowered to work hard to achieve academic success.

Additional services

A wide range of services offered to both residents and non-residents.

- Kan, I Help-Information Network
- Library Resources
- Suicide Prevention Lifeline
- Virtual Backpack allows hassle free sorting of information from the district and community organization.
- Bradley Central, East & West:ReportBullyingBE@bradleyschools.com.

Colorful highlights at the Bradley Public Library:

- Bradley Library awarded Project Next Generation (PNG)
- Family Market Day
- Free grocery
- "Calling all Poets "for short story writing 3rd grade through adults.
- "Say Yes To The Prom Dress."
- Bradley Public Library is officially fine free as of 9/1/2021,

  to erase economic barriers.

Governmental Offices in Bradley:

- Bradley Illinois Secretary of State Facility
- Bradley Municipal Building -
- Village of Bradley Administration
- Bradley City General
- Bradley Code Enforcement
- Bradley Street & Alley Department
- United States Postal Service

Utilities

Urban areas benefit from economic development through sustainable growth because of their utility infrastructure availability and operational efficiency. The financial performance experiences substantial improvement when public infrastructure develops electricity infrastructure alongside water supply systems and telecommunications networks. Modern utility services in Bradley allow businesses and residents to access essential resources, which promotes a suitable economic growth environment.

Electricity and Natural Gas

Bradley provides the industrial and residential energy foundation through electricity and natural gas services. ComEd is an electricity supplier that brings energy-saving solutions and contributes to achieving sustainable development goals. In addition, the existence of Nicor Gas adds to economic development as a firm guarantee of a natural gas supply for heating and industrial purposes. Business sustainability involves reliable energy sources that result in the reduction of operational costs and the improvement of business performance (Ekeocha et al., 2022). Therefore, Bradley businesses have an infrastructure conducive to growth that does not degrade the environment.

Water and Wastewater Management

Water and wastewater management play a key role in urban planning and environmental sustainability. The municipal water system provides clean water with safe standards, as state and federal law requires. Good wastewater treatment ensures that water resources protected for future generations. Bohman, Glaas, and Karlson (2019) underlined the need for sustainable stormwater management to integrate resilience into urban development. Bradley's investment in water conservation and stormwater infrastructure adds to the community's environmental sustainability and lowers long-term maintenance costs.

Telecommunications and Broadband

Delivering telephone signals with broadband and fiber-optic connections creates essential bases for increasing digital advancement and regional economic competitiveness. Due to dependable internet access, businesses can conduct e-commerce while implementing telework systems and innovation. Modern telecommunications infrastructure projects create an attractive business climate and resident-friendly conditions, solidifying Bradley's dedication to technological development.

Change of Zoning Process

The Village of Bradley's Planning & Zoning process ensures that all development projects comply with local regulations, zoning ordinances, and community development goals. Whether you are seeking annexation, zoning changes, or development approvals, this guide provides the necessary steps, fees, and requirements for your application.

Application Process

All applications, supporting documents, and applicable fees must be submitted to the Community Development Department. Applications requiring public hearings must be submitted at least 45 days before a scheduled Planning & Zoning Commission meeting. Public notice requirements include newspaper publication (paid by the applicant), signage on the property, and certified mail notifications to nearby property owners. The Planning & Zoning Commission meets on the first Tuesday of each month, with meeting agendas posted at Village Hall 48 hours in advance.

Types of Requests

Applicants may submit requests for the following:

- Annexation (Residential & Non-Residential)
- Zoning Changes
- Special Use Permits

- Planned Development (Residential & Non-Residential)
- Preliminary & Final Development Plans
- Subdivision Plats (Preliminary & Final)
- Variance Requests
- Appeals

Each request type has specific documentation requirements and fee structures.

Fee Schedule

Fees vary based on the type and scope of the request.

Bradley Planning & Zoning Review Fees

Table 5. Bradley Planning & Zoning Review Fees

ACTION REQUESTED	FEE
Annexation - Application Fee	Residential (single lot): $50 plus Annexation fee*. Residential (multiple lots): $150 plus $25 per acre & Annexation fee. Non-residential: $250 plus $25 per acre & Annexation fee
Annexation Fee	Residential (single lot): $100. Residential (multiple lots): $350 per acre. Non-residential: $350 per acre
Zoning Upon Annexation	$700, plus the cost of newspaper publication (TBD)**
Variance	$700, plus the cost of newspaper publication (TBD)**
Special Use Permit	$700, plus the cost of newspaper publication (TBD)**
Change of Zoning	$700, plus the cost of newspaper publication (TBD)**
Preliminary or Final Development Plan Review	25 acres or less: $250 Between 26 & 50 acres: $400 51 acres & greater: $600 Plus the cost of 3rd party review fees (TBD)***
Planned Development (Residential, Commercial, or Industrial)	$700, plus the cost of newspaper publication (TBD)**Plus the cost of 3rd party review fees
Preliminary or Final Plat of Subdivision	5 acres or less: $500 6 acres or greater: $ I00 per acre Plus the cost of 3rd party review fees (TBD)***

**Fee waived if residence is already receiving Village sewer or water services, for residential single lot only*

***Actual charge for publication will be calculated by newspaper company and forwarded to applicant by the Village, Applicant shall pay these costs to the Village no less than seven (7) days prior to hearing date,*

****All plans that require a 3rd party review will need to execute a signed escrow agreement with the Village of Bradley for the appropriate amount of review services needed.*

Final fees depend on property size, complexity, and additional engineering or publication costs.

Public Hearing & Notice Requirements

Specific requests require a public hearing before approval by the Village Board of Trustees. Change of Zoning or Zoning Upon Annexation, Special Use Permits. and Approval of a Planned Development shall granted or denied by the Village Board of Trustees only after a Public Hearing before the Planning & Zoning Commission and a report of its findings and recommendations has been submitted to the Village Board of Trustees. A Variance Request shall be granted or denied by the Village Board of Trustees only after a Public Hearing before the Planning & Zoning Commission and a report of its approval or failure to receive approval has been submitted to the Village Board of Trustees.

Submission Requirements

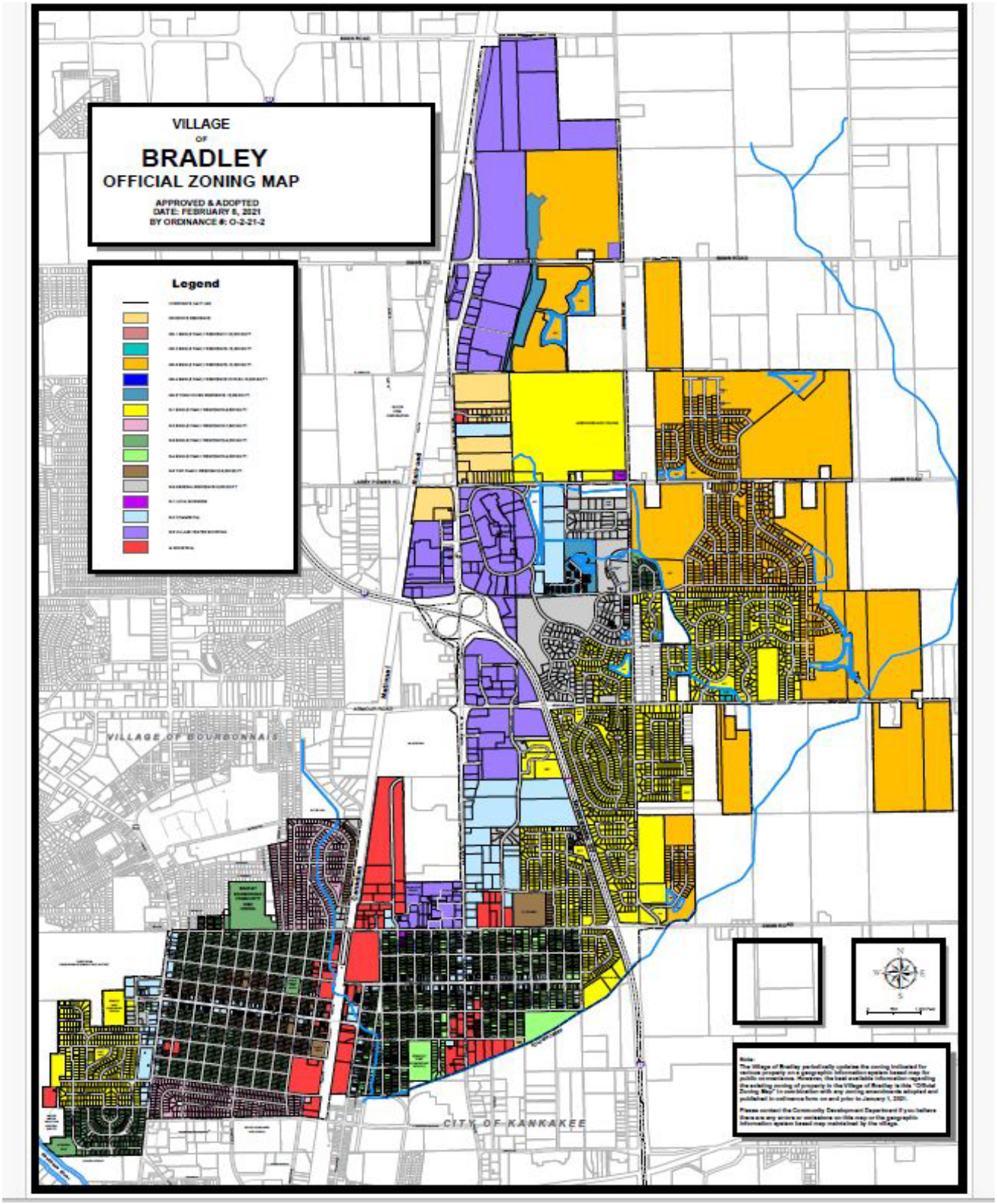
Each application must include:

- Completed application form.
- Plat of survey and legal property description.
- Supporting site plans, narratives, and architectural drawings (as required).
- Payment of all applicable fees.
- Certain applications may also require engineering drawings, stormwater management plans, and regulatory compliance statements.

Contact Information

For questions or assistance with applications, contact: Bruce Page Director, Community Development Department, 111 N. Michigan Ave., Bradley, IL 60915. Phone: (815) 936-5100 ext. 1111, Email: bepage@bradleyil.org Forms and detailed information at:Https://Bradleyil.Org/Media/Planning-And-Zoning-Packet-Updated-Min.

Zoning Map



Source: Interactive ArcGIS web application for geographic data (2025). Bradley. Retrieved from: https://bradleyil.maps.arcgis.com/apps/webappviewer/index.html?id=ba4606a73d054f75a37446947f11d5cc

Building Department Documents

The Village of Bradley Building department's role is overseeing the permitting application process, conducting inspections, enforcing building codes, and recording maintenance from these activities related to new or modified construction.

International Codes, or I-Codes, are the source model codes and standards that are embedded application approval process. Municipal government will adopt codes through a governing body with votes after code proposals, committee review and public hearings. The International Codes, or I-Codes standards in Bradley:

- 2021 International Building Code (IBC)
- 2021 International Residential Code (IRC)
- 2021 International Fire Code (IFC)
- 2021 International Mechanical Code (IMC)
- 2021 International Fuel Gas Code (IFGC)
- 2021 International Property Maintenance Code (IPMC)
- 2021 International Swimming Pool &

Spa Code

- 2021 ICC Performance Code
- 2020 National Electrical Code (NFPA 70)
- Current Illinois Energy Conservation Code
- Illinois Plumbing Code
- Illinois Accessibility Code

Per the Village of Bradley website, “any other unit of local government does not have the authority to grant relief, change or amend any code or portion thereof. The codes listed are mandatory State law and latest versions are always applicable.” Building department documentation reflects these standards which includes:

1. Building Permit:
    - Authorizations for construction, renovation, or demolition projects.
    - Project description (type of construction, renovation, or demolition).
    - Site plans and architectural drawings.
2. Construction Plans:
    - Detailed blueprints, including structural, electrical, plumbing, and HVAC designs.
    - Compliance with local building codes and zoning regulations and special permits granted.
3. Inspection Reports:
    - Records of inspections to ensure compliance with building codes and safety standards thus issuing a certificate of occupancy.
    - Notices of any code violations of building codes or regulations.

Economic Development

Village of Bradley Available Properties

Village's Available Properties can fuel economic growth in Bradley. Bradley is most known for some of its most popular attractions. These attractions include, Perry Farm, Looney Bin, Olive's Bar and Grill, Hero City Adventure Park and Paradox Emporium. Presently, there are 22 Commercial Real Estate listings for sale near Bradley, Illinois.

Bradley is home to a variety of local businesses and nationally recognized brands, including an offering of hotel accommodations. Bradley's available properties among real estate listings include condos, town homes and single-family homes for sales. Commercial properties are also available. The Hines Global Income Trust's Bradley Business Center listing, which includes Compass Health Center who provides mental health services, Power Home Remodeling Group,

LLC offers home remodeling services, CCG Chicago, LLC: Operates an automobile storage facility and ClimbZone Chicago is a family entertainment and indoor amusement center.

Village of Bradley Commercial Land

Source: Interactive ArcGIS web application for geographic data (2025). Bradley. Retrieved from: https://bradleyil.maps.arcgis.com/apps/webappviewer/index.html?id=ba4606a73d054f75a37446947f11d5cc

Opportunities

Kinzie Avenue/Route 50is the retail and hospitality hub and the conterminous Kankakee-Bourbonnais-Bradley Metropolitan Statistical Area (MSA). Key anchors include Behring and Nucor, both who recently made significant investments in their operations; and the 530,000-square-foot Northfield Square Mall, which is experiencing the loss of four out of five anchors and significant vacancy. The corridor also includes a mix of smaller, locally owned businesses in the south with national retailers to the north. The West Broadway Corridor, west from Kinzie Avenue/Route 50 to Kennedy Drive is the Villages original central business district and includes a mix of commercial and residential uses. Key anchors include the Village municipal complex, post office and other community-focused facilities.

Bradley's Market Conditions (Residential)

A variety of housing options typically provides households of all ages and income cohorts the opportunity to live within a community. Today, Bradley's housing is predominantly single-family owner- and renter-occupied housing. Housing preferences are shifting away from homeownership, both locally and regionally. This shift aligns with wider trends in residential development that are leading towards more compact development and greater preference for rental housing. In the future, it is anticipated that there will be more renters who could afford to own a home but still choose to rent.

Bradley's Market Conditions (Retail)

Over 80% of the County/MSA's total retail product is in Bradley, which establishes Bradley as the retail and commercial hub of the region. The two corridors encompass most of the retail and commercial properties in Bradley except properties along Kennedy/Avenue (US Route 45/52) and the north street. Bradley real estate listings include condos, town homes and single-

family homes for sale. Commercial properties are also available.

Bradley's Market Conditions (Other Market Opportunities)

The regional office market characterized primarily as a mix of smaller, professional office and medical offices. Most of the existing office supply is located outside of Bradley, with the Village accounting for only 7% of the existing office supply in the County/MSA. Commercial real estate properties include office space for sale, retail space for sale and land for sale.

The Village of Bradley new website design will be an innovative strategy to advertise and increase growth with community enhancements to maximize it community's curb appeal by

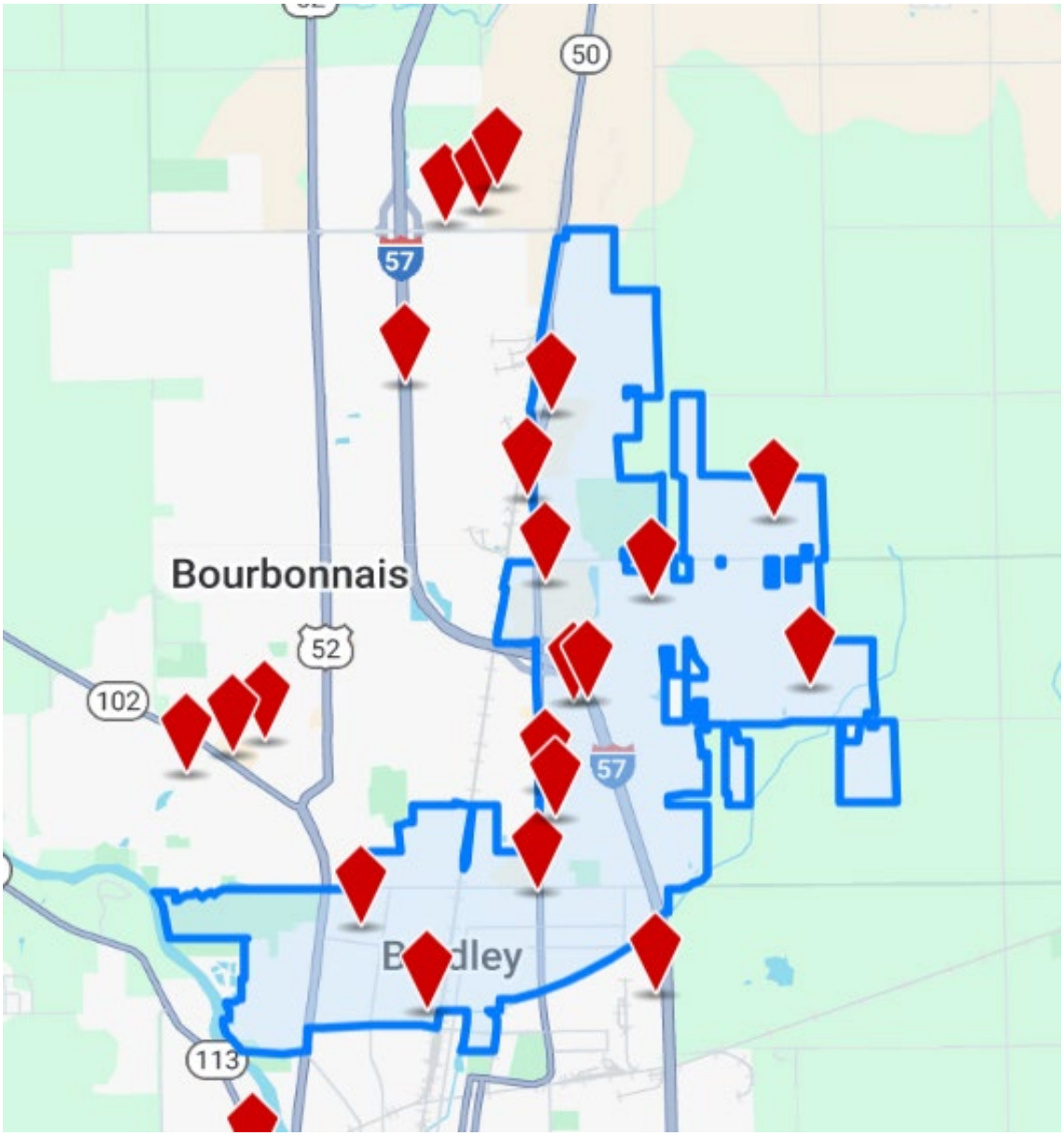
inviting businesses to generate revenue for both commercial and retail businesses. This approach can foster sustainable growth and build economic wealth for generations to come. The Village of Bradley should continue incorporating marketing strategies coupled with market analysis to assess cost effectiveness.

However, based on multiple real estate listings, land space is readily available for both small businesses and multi-family businesses. As such, any existing vacant land space can be good soil to build on. Therefore, proposing a parking garage would offer visitors and business owners accessibility to safe parking while merchants and patrons tour some of Bradley's central attractions while shopping and dining. Given the history of Bradley's reputation for building, I believe that Bradley new web design can serve as the vehicle for inviting businesses to town. It can create diversity and open new opportunities for future establishments for years to come.

Bradley IL Real Estate & Commercial for Sale - 7 Available Properties found:
1). Bar Grill Music Sports Patio – 1010 W. Broadway Street Bradley, IL. 60915
2). Mix Used Business Opportunities – 423 W. Broadway Street Bradley, IL. 60915
3). Multi-Family Business Opportunities – 110 Broadway Street Bradley, IL. 60915
4). Multi-Family Business Opportunities – 458 W. Broadway, Bradley, IL 60915

5). Retail Business Opportunities 120 N. Cleveland Avenue Bradley, IL 60915
6). Retail Business Opportunities 253 W Broadway Street Bradley, IL. 60915
7). Office Business Opportunities 511 N. Street Bradley, IL 60915
Coldwellbankertoday.com,loopnet.com, commerical.century21.com

Available properties for sale based on LoopNet.



Source: LoopNet (2025). Bradley, IL. Retrieved from www.loopnet.com/search/commercial-real-estate/bradley-il/for-sale/?sk=33c7bd7c1e463e6942cf7cd1054a797f.

Grants & Business Assistance Programs

Local Grant Program

Façade Improvement & Beautification Grant Program

The Façade improvement and Beautification program is a new policy set by the Village of Bradley to provide a 50% matching grant towards Bradley business or building owners who construct eligible improvements to the facades and streetscapes of their buildings. The Village intends to match costs of up to $15,000 on eligible projects that improve the appearance of their building's storefront, façade and streetscape.

Goal

The Village of Bradley has decided to support the renewal of street fronts given the benefits it provides towards aesthetics and community building, while also promoting commercial growth. By working hand in hand with small businesses, Bradley hopes to support its community and promote growth.

Eligible Beautification Properties & Applicants and Eligible Improvements

This subsection is entered into a separate file one can click on the page to see relevant information. This is to save space and declutter, allowing one to still find this information handy as well:

- *Eligible Properties and Applicants-*
    1. Only one grant will be awarded per building within a five-year period.
    2. Only improvements to facades and streetscapes that directly front a public right-of-way are eligible for funding.
    3. Any building with a zoning or building code violation is NOT eligible for the program.
    4. Any commercial building owner, or business owner with building owner authorization, may apply for the grant.
- *Eligible Improvements-*

Three of the following eligible improvements must be incorporated into the overall improvements:

- Exterior Doors and Storefront Windows
- Streetscape Elements
- Landscaping
- Painting
- Shutters and Awnings
- Stairs, Porches, Railings
- Wall Façade Repair & Treatment
- Exterior Lighting
- Roofs visible from the Street
- Original Architectural Features repair or replacement
- Signage Repair or Replacement (Free standing pole or monument signs are not an eligible improvement) All requests for signage as part of the façade program are subject to further review.
- Improvements for ADA compliance

- *Application*
- *Terms*

The terms of the program are as follows:

1. Grants are issued in the form of reimbursements after eligible expenses incurred (receipts or other acceptable proof of payment are required).
2. Reimbursement is limited to a maximum of 50% of verified eligible expenses.
3. Maximum grant amount to be awarded to a single project under the program is $15,000 (50% of $30,000 of verified eligible expenses).

4. The program may not be used by the same applicant to renovate the same store front (tenant space) more than once.
5. The current annual funding for the program varies per TIF District and is subject to adjustment in conjunction with the Village's budget process.

Federal Grant Programs

U.S Small Business Administration (SBA)

Created in 1953, the U.S. Small Business Administration (SBA) continues to help small business owners and entrepreneurs pursue the American dream. SBA is the only cabinet-level federal agency fully dedicated to small business and provides counseling, capital, and contracting expertise as the nation's only go-to resource and voice for small businesses.

State Loan Programs

The Illinois Department of Commerce

The mission of the Illinois Department of Commerce and Economic Opportunity (DCEO) is to create equitable economic opportunities across the State of Illinois. By attracting and supporting major job creators, investing in communities, strengthening Illinois' world-class workforce, fostering innovation, and ushering in the new clean energy economy, DCEO works to fortify Illinois' reputation as a global economic powerhouse while ensuring Illinois is the best state to live, work and do business. Site: dceo.illinois.gov/businesshelp/smallbusinessassistance.html.

Additional Local Loan Programs

Rail Freight Loan Program

The purpose of the Rail Freight Loan Program is to provide capital assistance to communities, railroads, and shippers to preserve and improve rail freight service in Illinois. The primary role of the program is to facilitate investments in rail service by serving as a link between interested parties and channeling government funds to projects that achieve statewide economic development. The

program generally provides low interest loans to finance rail improvements. Under exceptional circumstances grants may be considered.

Illinois Small Business Development Centers

Illinois Small Business Development Centers are located throughout the state and provide information, confidential business guidance, training, and other resources for start-ups and existing small businesses. Site: dceo.illinois.gov/smallbizassistance/beginhere/sbdc.html.

Illinois SBDC at South Suburbs

Small Business Development Center (SBDC):

-*Contact:* Felicitas Cortez, 4137 Sauk Trail , Richton Park IL 60471 , 312-853-3477

-*Site:* fcortez@wbdc.org Weblink: ilsbdc.ecenterdirect.com/signup?centerid=19

TIFs

Tax Increment Financing (TIF) has been a strategic tool for the Village of Bradley to bolster economic development, generate investment, and rejuvenate key sectors of the community. A key component of TIF districts is contributing to enhancing the infrastructure, promoting business growth, and enriching the economic environment of a community while not increasing the residents' tax burden. These initiatives have also contributed to reviving parts of towns that were neglected and not attractive to potential businesses and investors (Dixon Growth and Economic Development Corporation, 2025).

Currently, Bradley has established three TIF districts:

1. **Larry Power Road TIF (Created in August 2008)**
   - This district primarily encompasses the Belson Steel property, a significant industrial site in the village.
   - The TIF fund concluded with a balance of $31,406 in FY2022, demonstrating a stable fiscal impact on local economic growth.
1. **State Route 50 TIF (Created in July 2006)**

- This TIF district includes the Bradley Commons Shopping Center, Aldi, and other prominent retail establishments along Route 50.
- The initiative aims to support infrastructure improvements and foster commercial expansion in one of the village's busiest corridors.

TIF 17 Map

Source: Interactive ArcGIS web application for geographic data (2025). TIFs Bradley. Retrieved from: https://bradleyil.maps.arcgis.com/apps/webappviewer/index.html?id=ba4606a73d054f75a37446947f11d5cc

TIF 20

In 2023, the Village of Bradley has partnered a contract with SB Freidman Development Advisors for $40,000 to uncover the benefits of incorporating a Tax Increment Financing district within the area of the 27 village-owned acreage southeast and north of the mall up to St. George Road. Phase I begins the bid and request for proposal (RFP). Phase II includes planning and designs for the Aquatic water park, with a minimum of eight baseball and softball fields to accommodate league teams, a massive indoor state-of-the-art minimum 70,000 square footage turf facility, with an additional 75,000 square footage slated to house a conference center, brewery, entertainment sites, and outdoor festival grounds.

TIF 20 Map

Source: Interactive ArcGIS web application for geographic data (2025). TIFs Bradley. Retrieved from https://bradleyil.maps.arcgis.com/apps/webappviewer/index.html?id=ba4606a73d054f75a37446947f11d5cc.

Encompassing eighty-one commercial, residential, and vacant parcels, this TIF enhances mixed-use development and creates new opportunities for local businesses and residents. Additionally, Bradley is actively developing TIF 20, an initiative to transform 27 acres of village-owned land southeast and north of the mall up to St. George Road. With this initiative, Bradley aims to stimulate sustainable urban growth with private-sector participation.

- In 2023, the village contracted with SB Friedman Development Advisors in a $40,000 contract to analyze this TIF district's potential benefits, if any.
- Phase I involves bid requests and planning, while Phase II entails designs for an aquatic water park, a multi-field sports complex, and a state-of-the-art 70,000-square-foot indoor turf facility. It also sets aside a 75,000-square-foot area for a conference center, brewery, entertainment venues, and festival grounds.

Residents and investors can explore these TIF districts through Bradley's interactive ArcGIS web application: bradleyil.maps.arcgis.com/apps/webappviewer/index.

Enterprise Zone Maps and Information

Bradley employs essential development tools, including the Enterprise Zones. However, these zones offer businesses tax incentives, financial aid, and regulatory flexibility to attract investments and create job opportunities. The Business Retention and Expansion Program has identified Enterprise Zones as essential to Bradley's long-term economic plan. It has been proven that these zones have an impact to stimulate economic activity and to promote regional cooperation.

Key benefits of Enterprise Zones include:

- Property tax abatements for eligible businesses.
- Sales tax exemptions on building materials for construction and renovation projects.
- Investment tax credits to encourage business growth and expansion.
- Infrastructure improvements to support development. These improvements continue to modernize key areas for new and expanding businesses to be more appealing.

Bradley is located within the Kankakee County Enterprise Zone, a multiple municipality zone that serves the region with economic development. In this zone, incentives have been used to attract businesses to Bradley, so this zone has been pivotal in enticing businesses to consider Bradley because the incentives make it financially viable. It has also attracted different world industries, enhancing the village's economic terrain. For more information, businesses and developers can visit the following website: kankakeecountyed.org/about-us/news-and-updates/enterprise-zones-in-kankakee-county-your-engines-for-jobs-and-investment.

TIF districts and Enterprise Zones together make Bradley a real place for business investment for continued and lasting economic growth for the community. Utilizing these financial

tools, Bradley continues to create a business-friendly environment and stays at the forefront of economic development.

The Kankakee River Valley Enterprise Zone

Village of Bradley is part of the Kankakee River Valley Enterprise Zone, one of two Enterprise Zones in Kankakee County. This zone encompasses areas within Aroma Park, Bourbonnais, Bradley, Kankakee, Herscher, and unincorporated Kankakee County (Economic Alliance of Kankakee County, 2024, 2025).

State and local tax incentives in the Village of Bradley

Depending on the type of project, businesses may be eligible for the following state and local tax incentives in the Village of Bradley:

Property Tax Abatement

New construction projects in Bradley are eligible for property tax abatements in participating taxing districts, structured as follows:

- Year 1: 100%
- Year 2: 80%
- Year 3: 60%
- Year 4: 40%
- Year 5: 20%

Free or Discounted Building Permits

The Village of Bradley offers free building permits, though inspection fees are charged according to local authority policies. Building materials eligible for enterprise zone sales tax exemptions include items permanently affixed to real property, such as lumber, mortar, glued-down carpets, and wallpaper.

Investment Tax Credit

Businesses in Bradley can receive a 0.5% credit against state income tax for investments in "qualified property" placed in service within the enterprise zone. "Qualified property" includes tangible assets like buildings, structural components, material tanks, elevators, and major computer installations.

Machinery and Equipment Sales Tax Exemption

Businesses can obtain a sales tax exemption on machinery and equipment, provided they secure state certification and meet qualifying criteria.

Utility Tax Exemption

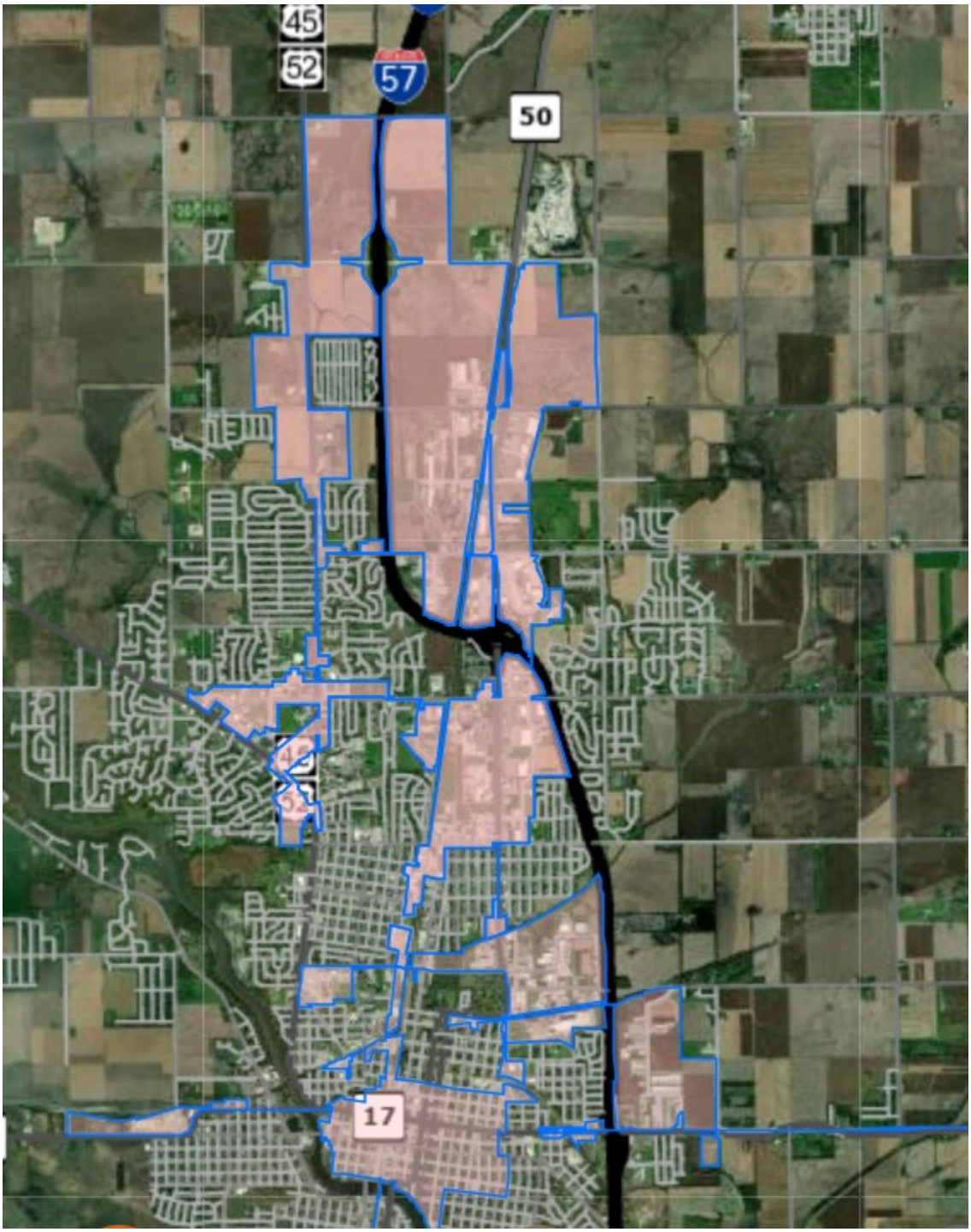
Companies in Bradley may qualify for a 5% exemption on state taxes for gas, electricity, and certain telecommunications, pending state certification and meeting specific criteria.

The Kankakee Riverfront Opportunity Zone in Kankakee

Opportunity Zones are an economic development tool that allows people to invest in distressed areas in the United States. Their purpose is to spur economic growth and job creation in low-income communities while providing tax benefits to investors.

The Kankakee Riverfront Opportunity Zone in Kankakee

Source: https://bradleyil.maps.arcgis.com/apps/webappviewer/index.html?id=ba4606a73d054f75a37446947f11d5cc



Source: https://bradleyil.maps.arcgis.com/apps/webappviewer/index.html?id=ba4606a73d054f75a37446947f11d5cc

Conclusions and Recommendations

The cohort developed a website for Bradley Economic Development Corporation. The students put together a website packet combining the following information as requested by the Village of Bradley:

BEDC

- Mission Statement
- About the BEDC
- Board of Directors
- Staff
- Contact Us
- Suggestion

Village of Bradley

- Community Profile
- Demographics
- Transportation
- Other Local Governments-Schools, County, etc.
- Utilities
- Change of Zoning Process
- Zoning Map ,
- Building department Documents

Economic Development

- Available properties
- Local Grants & Business Assistance Programs (Create Commercial Facade Grant Program & Small Business Loan Program)
- TIFs (Include Maps)

- Enterprise Zone Maps and Information

The Village of Bradley will use this group's proposal to create BEDC website.

Recommendations for Board of Directors and Staff

We recommend "The Strategic Plan Cycle" process for BEDC. "This process is designed to organize effective participation for all stakeholders. Starting a new economic development board with the staff positions as outlined is an opportunity to foster growth and prosperity in Bradley, Illinois. The "Cycle" builds competency to responses to actions, results, and challenge outcomes to each step. As such, BEDC may adopt strategies during implementation to evaluate its mission progress timely. Key steps noted to ensure the BEDC operates effectively and achieves its goals:

1. Define Clear Goals and Objectives
    a. Establish measurable short- and long-term economic development goals.
    b. Align objectives with the needs of the community, such as job creation, infrastructure improvement, or small business support.
2. Create a Collaborative Framework
    a. Encourage open communication and regular coordination between the Village Director Liaison, Business Analyst Manager, Property & Grant Manager, and Partnerships & Special Projects Manager.
    b. Develop a shared vision to avoid silos and ensure all positions complement each other.
3. Utilize Data and Analysis
    a. Leverage the Business Analyst Manager's expertise to create a data-driven strategy for identifying opportunities and tracking progress.
    b. Use economic trend analyses to inform board decisions and initiatives.
4. Focus on Partnerships

   a. a. Task the Partnerships & Special Projects Manager about building alliances with local businesses, nonprofits, educational institutions, and government agencies.
   b. Pursuing public-private partnerships to maximize funding and resources for key projects.

5. Optimize Grant Opportunities
   a. Empower the Property & Grant Manager to actively seek and manage grants that align with development goals.
   b. Explore opportunities for federal, state, and private grants to diversify funding sources.

6. Engage the Community
   a. Host community forums and events to gather feedback, share progress, and build public support.
   b. Create programs that involve local businesses and residents, fostering a sense of ownership in the board's initiatives.

7. Encourage Professional Development
   a. Offer training and development opportunities for all staff members to ensure they stay informed about the latest industry practices and trends.
   b. Promote cross-training to enhance collaboration and flexibility within the team.

8. Monitor and Evaluate Performance
   a. Set up a system for regular performance reviews of both staff and initiatives.
   b. Use these evaluations to refine strategies and adapt to changing needs or challenges.

9. Public Relations and Branding
   a. Develop a strong brand identity for the board to communicate its purpose and successes.

b. Share success stories and milestones to build trust and attract more support from stakeholders.

10. Leverage Technology and Innovation
    a. Invest in tools and platforms to streamline grant management, data analysis, and stakeholder communication.
    b. Explore innovative solutions, such as green technologies to position the region as forward-thinking and competitive.
11. Performance Metrics
    a. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):
        - Number of new businesses established.
        - Jobs created and retained.
        - Community satisfaction surveys.
        - Grant funding secured.
        - Progress on special projects.
    b. Regular Reviews:
        - Conduct quarterly assessments of goals and initiatives.
        - Adjust strategies based on performance outcomes.
12. Timeline
    a. Year 1: Establish the board, hire staff, and develop foundational programs.
    b. Year 2–3: Execute initial projects, monitor progress, and refine strategies.
    c. Year 4–5: Evaluate long-term impact and identify future opportunities for growth.
13. Budget and Resources
    a. Allocate funding for staff salaries, programs, and marketing efforts.
    b. Include projections for grants and other revenue sources.

Recommendation For Development of Transportation

From an economic perspective, transportation systems are vital and can play a critical role among rural communities as they pertain to employment and sustainable growth. The Village of Bradley is in Illinois, and it possesses a strong robust community that has a knack for building business and resources that connects its residents with full access to travel amenities through suburban transportation known as the River Valley Metro. The Metro has a variety of traditional routes that are efficient. Their mission is to provide safe transit resources for its citizens and visitors. This includes commuter shuttles and metro plus service for individuals with disabilities. This district has been operating since 1999, providing public transportation in the urbanized area of Kankakee County, including Bradley, Aroma Park, Bourbonnais, Kankakee, and Manteno. Currently, more than 350 bus stops are served. Services for individuals with disabilities who are unable to independently use a fixed route service. This is referred to as the Metro Plus service.

River Valley Metro has a shuttle that service Midway Airport. And the fare is only $2 each way. And access to Midway airport is a fast way to navigate through busy traffic congestion. The shuttle can be used as a convenience for your travel needs to the airport and downtown Chicago. Also, having access to taking a taxi from O'Hare to Midway is another convenient way to travel between the two airports. Rates will vary depending on the time of day. River Valley Metro Mass Transit District has now provided more than 10 million rides for the people of Kankakee County, surpassing the 10 million ride mark in June 2017. Commuter bus routes: Route 5 through route 14 and consists of Midway Airport, Shapiro, Kankakee Estates, Greyhound Terminal, Walmart (Kankakee), and South Harrison.

We would offer two recommendations to the Village of Bradley. The first recommendation would be to enhance Bradley's website by incorporating a Metra rail service to facilitate continuous growth by having the accessibility of other transport options. Integrating the Metra rail can foster efficiency with shorter commute time frames while navigating through the Village of Bradley and

through Kankakee County. in lieu of their new building expansion project. Bradley has the potential to become even more appealing to a diversified population given its up and up-and-coming newly built waterfront park, its newly built baseball diamond and annual music festival.

The second recommendation would be adopting the idea of an integrated transport system. To build a partnership with a share ride company such as Uber that would allow the Village an opportunity to shift the focus on health by responding to services for non-emergency transport to and from outpatient follow up clinic appointments and other non-emergency health related matters.

Recommendation For Grants

Sustainability Loans- The Village would provide loans of varying amounts to businesses that have resided in the area for at least a year. These bonuses would be increased, and the loan amount extended with better rates for certain time milestones to encourage retention of business.

The key idea for this program is to provide an additional incentive from the village itself for a business to consider before deciding to shutter their doors or move to a different area and do business. The same can be said for new businesses that may be looking for attractive partnership initiatives outside of just demographic conditions being met with a location. This can also be retooled to focus on tax cuts and other benefits that the village can provide if they do not wish to provide a loan, thus limiting their exposure, only paying through lost taxes.

Broadway Street as A Historic Zoning- I believe that with the division of old Bradley and New Bradley, labeling Broadway Street as historic Bradley can provide a lucrative compromise with the residents of Bradley who wish to further develop Broadway Street. This would create the balance where new development can occur near the current attractions being built, while Broadway Street retains its unique Midwestern identity. In addition, this would become an attraction within itself given its eateries and pubs, creating an opportunity to synergize a tour of venues.

Local Trolly/ Tram System- The idea of this would be to create a partnership with the willing hotels to set up a bussing system that can take hotel guests to the baseball diamonds, or the

concert that gets held periodically. This would alleviate traffic, reduce the streets to parking infrastructure and create greater incentive to stay at the hotels and indirectly reduce DUIs given an alternative to personally operating a vehicle during these exciting events. Overall, the idea would cost very little, with only one or two buses that can be scaled up as demand articulates itself.

VILLAGE OF BRADLEY
Façade & Streetscape Improvement Application

APPLICANT INFORMATION	
Name:	Phone:
Mailing Address:	Fax:
Email:	Federal Tax ID:

PROPERTY INFORMATION	
Address of Building for Grant Funding:	
Name of Building Owner:	
Property ID Number(s):	Phone:

PROPOSED IMPROVEMENTS Check all the Apply	
❒ Exterior Doors ❒ Streetscape Elements ❒ Landscaping ❒ Painting ❒ Shutters and Awnings ❒ Stairs, Porches, Railings ❒ Wall Façade Repair & Treatment	❒ Exterior Lighting ❒ Roofs visible from the Street ❒ Original Architectural Features Repair ❒ Signage Repair or Replacement ❒ Other: _____

PROPOSED IMPROVEMENTS
Please describe the scope of the proposed project below (include a summary of the building's current condition, areas to be improved and how, as well as any proposed materials of colors):

APPLICANT CHECK LIST	SIGNATURE
❒ Completed and signed Bradley Facade & Streetscape Grant Application ❒ Current photographs of the property to be improved (entire façade and details) ❒ Historical photograph of the property to be improved (if available) ❒ Drawings of proposed improvements (drawings do not have to be architectural renderings, but should be to scale to understand the proposed project). ❒ Color and material samples if relevant (material specifications supplied by manufacturer) ❒ Preliminary estimate of cost	I agree to comply with the guidelines and process of the Village of Bradley Façade and Streetscape Improvement and Beautification Program, and I understand that this is a voluntary program, under which the Village has the right to approve or deny any project or proposal or portions thereof. X Applicant Signature Date X Building Owner's Signature Date *(if different from applicant)*

Recommendation For Building Department Documents

The Village's permit process is manual (Table 5). An applicant must print the application from their website to submit it for review in person or mail. Manual processing delays permit approval thus turning off potential investors, loss of Village permit revenue, and potential non-compliance with safety standards.

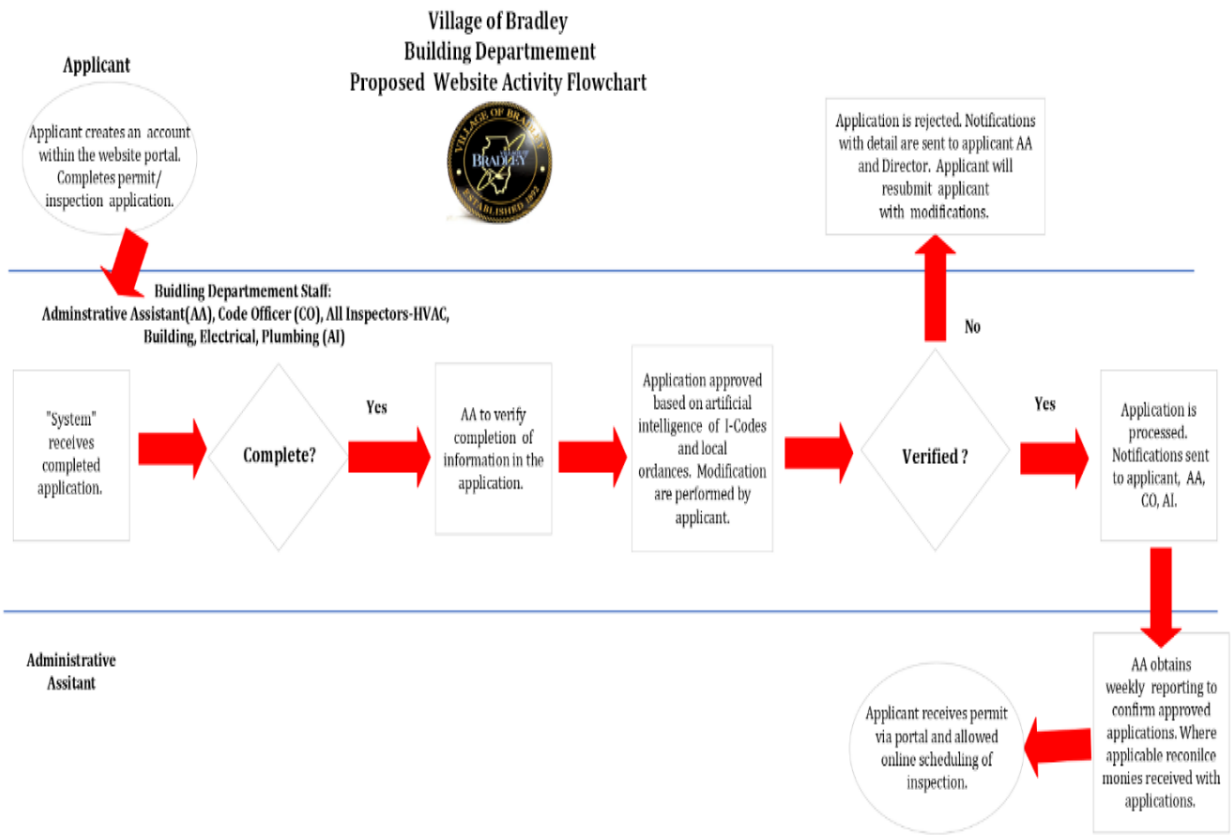
Table 6. Type of applications available website:

- Building Permit Application with Multiple Contractors
- Building Permit Application with Single Contractor
- Garage Packet
- Patio Packet
- Roof Packet
- Shed Packet
- Additions Packet
- Deck Packet
- Demolition Packet
- Driveway Packet
- Fence Packet
- Sidewalk Packet
- Swimming Pool Packet

BEDC's vision is to incorporate a link between its website and the building department that improve accessibility of these documents. As such there is a need for a comprehensive analysis to integrate permitting Information Technology to better serve public interests. For example, Chicago, for example, one can search for building permits, inspection, and violation records by address through the Department of Buildings website: chicago.gov/city/en/depts/bldgs.html.

We recommend that the Building Department Director must have a solid understanding of what IT architecture and infrastructure can offer the Building Department. Active collaboration between IT vendors and leadership is essential to ensure that technology decisions align with long-term business strategies that do not limit future possibilities. The proposed website flowchart (Ex. A) shows what can be expected from an applicant engagement, staff engagement, and IT system processing. This assessment will assist in communications between managements' vision to IT implementation.

IT Process Flow Chart



Furthermore, by integrating social engagement, Mobile accessibility, Analytics-driven insights, Cloud-based solutions, and Internet of Things innovations (SMACIT) framework strategy which meet today's demands and future-proof operations (Pearlson et al., 2024). Adopting the SMACIT framework offers a transformative opportunity for building departments to enhance their efficiency, engage effectively with the community, and embrace the future information technology. The framework highlights:

1. *Social (Customer Engagement)-*
    - Create a user-friendly mobile app or platform where residents can easily apply for permits, request inspections, or report issues.
    - Leverage social media channels to share updates, public notices, or highlight successful community projects.
2. *Mobile (Technology Access)-*

- Develop a mobile-first website that adapts seamlessly across devices for on-the-go users.
- Equip field inspectors with tablets or mobile devices to streamline on-site reporting and data collection.
- Introduce mobile payment options for permits, licenses, or other building department transactions.

3. *Analytics (Review Data and Adapt)-*
    - Use predictive analytics to identify trends in building permit applications and allocate resources accordingly.
    - Implement a dashboard that tracks department performance metrics like response times, application approvals, and community satisfaction.
4. *Cloud-*
    - Migrate departmental records, permits, and applications to a secure cloud platform for easier access and scalability.
    - Enable real-time collaboration between different teams via cloud-based project management tools.
5. *Internet of Things (IoT)-*
    - Integrate IoT devices like smart sensors in buildings to monitor construction progress or ensure compliance with safety standards.
    - Implement IoT-connected traffic or environmental sensors to guide planning and building projects.

The Director and staff must conduct a comprehensive assessment of current systems to identify specific areas where the SMACIT elements can add the most value. Prioritize initiatives that will have the highest impact on efficiency and community satisfaction, such as mobile-friendly applications and analytics for decision-making. Collaborate with stakeholders to implement these

strategies in a phased manner, ensuring smooth transitions and widespread adoption. With a clear roadmap and consistent evaluation, the building department can establish itself as a forward-thinking, digitally empowered organization.

Before deciding an IT transformation, the Village of Bradley must analyze best practices outlined in various municipal and state-level guides. Policy recommendations from Building Department staff and BCED members may offer actionable recommendations for improving documentation processes, including the adoption of digital systems, streamlining document templates, and training programs for staff. Streamlined documentation supports enhanced compliance with building codes and protects public safety.

Lastly, analyze prepackaged permit products or software for faster implementation. The costs are lower initially therefore reducing development time and technical skilled resources. Vendors provide continuous support, training, software updates and allowing Village staff administrative controls. Upgrades may be at no additional costs. Gives more time to focus on improving business versus IT software development.

Recommendations For Utilities

Bradley's utility infrastructure is the force behind driving economic development and sustainability. It provides reliable electricity, natural gas, water, wastewater management, and telecommunications services to businesses and residents for the essential resources. Bradley's economic resilience has also benefited from investments in sustainable stormwater management and broadband expansion. Given that the village is investing in its utility infrastructure, this makes it an appealing place for investment, thereby enabling long-term economic growth and environmental sustainability.

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Appendix

Source: CSL (2022). Tourism Asset Planning for Bradley, Illinois, Executive Summary, CSL, June 30, p.23